To use Prepared Statements, do not set query_log_tags_enabled.

From bin/rails console try running some Active Record queries.

```
User.first
```

Explore the saved prepared statements for your connections by running this code:

```
ActiveRecord::Base.connection.execute(
  'SELECT * FROM pg_prepared_statements'
).values
```

Prepared Statements have some incompatibilities so you may need to disable them. Besides being incompatible at publication time with Query Log Tags, they also don't work with some types of connection pooling and PgBouncer, which you'll work with in an upcoming chapter.

Ruby on Rails keeps innovating with prepared statements though. Prior to Rails 7, SELECT * was cached when fields weren't requested. In Rails 7 a setting enumerate_columns_in_select_statements was added[28] that enumerates the list of columns for SELECT statements, helping increase re-use of the prepared statement cache.

You've now seen how to use the Query Cache and Prepared Statements. Let's continue the cache theme, and look at Counter Caches.

Eliminating Slow Count Queries With Counter Caches

Another type of Active Record cache is aimed at improving slow COUNT() queries by using a pre-computed result instead.

This cache is called the *Counter Cache*. Counter Caches in Active Record keep a running tally of counts and store the tally in an integer column on a table.

In Rideshare, an example COUNT() query might be the number of trips a Driver has performed. This query could be done in high volume if many Riders are trying to access the trips count. Take a look at the following Active Record code to get the count of trips for a Driver.

```
Driver.first.trips.count
```

This code can be improved with a counter cache. First, this code is using .count() which always issues a SQL COUNT() query. Instead of .count() prefer the .size() method because it counts objects in memory when they're already loaded instead of issuing a SQL COUNT() query.

28. https://www.bigbinary.com/blog/rails-7-adds-setting-for-enumerating-columns-in-select-statements